Diego Palominos

Cloud Architect & Software Engineer

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SUMMARY

Cloud Architect and hands-on engineer, 13+ years building and running production systems, on AWS since 2014. I start from the business problem and make the tradeoffs explicit: at Electronic Payments I chose Magento as the storefront, moved orders, payments and POS sync into a distributed, event-driven middleware so nothing on the shop floor waits on the cloud, and standardized the platform as infrastructure as code. Founded Eleva, a multi-tenant SaaS on AWS, built end to end as a modular monolith.

CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- **Built a complete SaaS product:** founded Eleva and, as its sole architect and engineer, took it from idea to production on AWS as a modular monolith. Won **Start-Up Chile Ignite (2022)**.
- **Unified a retailer's online and in-store sales:** chose Magento as the almost-headless storefront; moved orders, payments and POS sync to an event-driven AWS middleware no register waits on.
- **Changed how a company ships:** Magento was hard to deploy, so I standardized it as infrastructure as code (CDK) and built the **company's first CI/CD pipelines**, now reused by other projects.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Software Architect, Electronic Payments

Feb 2024 – Present | Contract | Remote

- Liquor Cart: **on-premise registers must keep selling when the cloud fails**. Chose Magento as the storefront; moved orders, payments and POS sync to an event-driven AWS middleware.
- Built the .NET middleware for **resilience**: domain-driven services over RabbitMQ, retries, a replayable error queue, and a virtual host per store so a failure stays in that store. Wrote **about 90% of the C#**.
- Preferred a custom event-sourced layer (Marten) over plugins for **security and traceability**: idempotent payment actions, tokenized card data, and attributable catalog and order changes.
- Money and orders can disagree, so designed **payment recovery as a saga**: idempotent steps complete or cancel orders, void or refund payments, and escalate unresolved cases to a person.
- Standardized hard-to-deploy Magento as **infrastructure as code (CDK)** with the **company's first CI/CD pipelines**: identical, auditable, schedulable and patchable environments from local to production.
- Made the platform operable by the business: 40+ admin modules onboard **every new store, about 20,000 products, in around ten minutes**, and inspect or re-sync the integration without a developer.
- Set **observability and security as defaults**: OpenTelemetry traces, alarms, least-privilege IAM, encrypted secrets. The architecture and pipelines became **reference implementations other projects reuse**.
- Made a **six-person team** productive through conventions, reviews and mentoring, so juniors can touch production safely: 178 merged pull requests, **1,600+ unit tests on every push**.

Founder and Platform Architect, Eleva

2017 – Present | Own company · Start-Up Chile Ignite 2022 | Viña del Mar, Chile · Remote

- **Designed, built and took the entire SaaS platform to production**: frontend, backend, data model, AWS infrastructure, automation and operations, ready to scale out on ECS Fargate.
- Eleva runs whole-school staff evaluations: it generates a **200-person school's evaluations in about five minutes** and consolidates the school's progress in **under 20 seconds**.

Founder and Platform Architect, Eleva (continued)

- Chose a **modular monolith** over microservices for a one-engineer platform: explicit module scopes and a multi-tenant configuration layer, so new features land as a module or tenant override, not a rewrite.
- Evaluations affect careers, so a 360-degree process **freezes its configuration at creation**: results keep the rubric they were judged by, with per-school access scopes and evidence management.
- Innovating with schools demanded agile delivery: environments as code (CDK) and CI/CD with ECS auto-rollback. **19 production deployments in 30 days, none failed**, each live in **about nine minutes**.
- Designed for low operating cost: the .NET application tolerates scheduled shutdowns, so ECS and RDS stop outside school hours. An operations panel shows configuration drift and traces each release to its commit.
- Folding AI in as an assistant, not a judge: it drafts feedback and summarizes evidence, while scores, stage transitions and reports stay deterministic and auditable.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Senior Full-Stack Software Engineer, GRUBBRR
Apr 2022 – Aug 2023 | Contract | Boca Raton, FL · Remote

- Worked on the C#/.NET Core backend (GraphQL, gRPC, Cosmos DB) of a self-service kiosk platform, from requirements through production troubleshooting. Built the Angular 13 frontend for Clover SMB.

Software Engineer, Freelance
Jan 2014 – Jul 2020 | Full-time | Remote

- Helped clients launch MVPs: apps in Angular, React, Node.js, .NET Core, Java and Spring Boot, deployed on AWS infrastructure I designed and maintained.

PHP Full-Stack Developer, Centro Científico Tecnológico de Valparaíso
Feb 2013 – Jul 2014 | Part-time | Valparaíso, Chile · On-site

- Worked on SQL databases and PHP/ORM code for research tools at CCTVal, a scientific computing center.

EDUCATION

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Systems Engineering
Ingeniería de Ejecución en Sistemas Computacionales — Universidad Técnica Federico Santa María (UTFSM), Valparaíso, Chile

SKILLS

Languages and frameworks: C#, .NET (Core through 9), TypeScript, Angular (2–19), RxJS, Node.js, React, MassTransit, Marten, EF Core

Cloud and infrastructure: AWS (ECS Fargate, RDS, Aurora, ElastiCache, S3, CloudFront, API Gateway, Amazon MQ, Secrets Manager, CloudFormation), CDK, Projen, Infrastructure as Code, Docker

Delivery, security and observability: CI/CD, environment parity, approval gates, scheduled power-down, patching, drift detection, least-privilege IAM, KMS encryption, Veracode, OpenTelemetry, CloudWatch

Architecture: Distributed systems, modular monoliths, clean architecture, Domain-Driven Design, Event-Driven Architecture, Event Sourcing, CQRS, sagas, transactional outbox, idempotency, multitenancy, hybrid cloud

Data, messaging, commerce and testing: PostgreSQL, RabbitMQ, Redis, OpenSearch, SymmetricDS, Magento 2.4, Hyvä, POS integration, payment gateways (TokenEx, RapidConnect), xUnit, Playwright, Jest

LANGUAGES

Spanish (native) · English (professional working proficiency)